

cial crisis, which has compelled holders of stocks upon a large scale to realize. In other words, when prosperity is beginning to revive after a prolonged stagnation, and the prices of stocks are very low, the bull speculator's great chance occurs. When the great industries of a nation seem to rise as from the grave, and where lifelessness and inactivity ruled before the blows of the hammer resound and the blast furnace roars, a new life springs through the arteries of the commercial system, and the result is a rise in public securities. The solid rise in the price of stocks is that caused by the hard money-buying by a public that is well to do. At such a time the bull speculator should be in the van, for then the golden harvest prepared for his special sickle invites the reaper. Every trade gets its turn to a certainty. We will say, during a period of prosperity, a general recovery of the sounder stocks to a level at which they yield on the money invested  $4\frac{1}{2}$  per cent. per annum, takes two years from the time the advance had fairly set in. During that two years is the bull speculator's opportunity. If he does not make money then, he never will. Now we come more to the minutiae: "Any jackass can take a profit, but it requires a devilish clever fellow to cut a loss," is a well-worn expression in the city of London, but there never was a truer one. During the two years of recovery in prices to which we have referred, there will be a great number of small periods of time when the bull speculator should be out of the markets altogether. To decide when those periods are to be is his *pons asinorum*. After he has once realized the importance of having his accounts open ready for the periodical waves to carry him in and land his profit, the difficulty is to get him to realize the importance of keeping out while the water sweeps back, carrying with it the greedy speculators, who were not content to take their profits.